WSPR Logger on your phone

The mobile app: the live map, propagation, replay, history, analysis and the car's track in one hand

Otso Laakso (OH2GAX)

`https://wspr.oh2gax.org/app` · `https://github.com/oh2gax/wspr_logger`

In short. The phone view (the "mobile app") shows the same data as the full WSPR Logger page, made for a phone screen: **one view at a time, filling the screen**, and **every choice in the menu** behind the ≡ button at the top left. There is nothing to install: open `https://wspr.oh2gax.org/app` in the phone's browser, and if you like, add it to the home screen so that it opens like an app (Section 1). It has nine views:

- **Live map** and **Now** — where the car is, how well it is heard, the space weather (Sections 4.1–4.2);
- **Reporters** and **MUF graph** — the stations of the last hour and the ionosonde (Sections 4.3–4.4);
- **Replay**, **History** and **Statistics** — any earlier moment or day (Sections 4.5–4.7);
- **Analysis** — the full page's Propagation Analysis, card under card (Section 4.8);
- **WPRS** — the car's drives and trips as tracks (Section 4.9).

The user interface is the same as in the author's MODE-S Wind phone view, so if you know one, you know the other. What the numbers and charts *mean* is explained in the *WSPR Logger — User guide*; this guide tells where to find them on the phone.

About the figures. The screenshots were taken on a phone-sized screen (390 × 844 points) with the station's own data as it was on 6 November 2026 at 14:20 UTC. On the maps of the figures the background is a plain outline of the continents; in the app it is a detailed street map. The numbers on your screen will differ, because the data grows every ten minutes.

Contents

1 Opening the app **2**

2 The screen **2**

3 The menu **3**

4 The views **4**

4.1 Live map . . . 4
4.2 Now . . . 5
4.3 Reporters . . . 5
4.4 MUF graph . . . 6
4.5 Replay . . . 6
4.6 History . . . 7
4.7 Statistics . . . 8
4.8 Analysis . . . 8
4.9 WPRS . . . 9

5 Staying up to date **9**

6 The phone view and the full page **10**

7 Quick reference **10**

1 Opening the app

The address. Open `https://wspr.oh2gax.org/app` in the phone's browser (Safari, Chrome, Firefox, Samsung Internet . . .). On the full page the same link is in the top-left corner, under What's new: Phone app. The full page itself still works on a phone, but its menu and floating panels are made for a mouse and a wide screen; the phone view is easier to use with one thumb.

On the home screen. The app can be added to the home screen like any web app. It then opens full screen, without the browser's address bar, with its own icon (a green beacon sending blue waves):

- **iPhone, iPad** (Safari): the Share button → Add to Home Screen → Add.
- **Android** (Chrome): the ⋮ menu → Add to Home screen or Install app.

Nothing is installed from an app store and no account is needed; the app is the web page.

What is kept on the phone. The view you were on, the switches and choices of the menu, the map zoom, the theme and the version of the notes you have read are stored in the browser (its local storage). The next time you open the app it continues where you left it. In a private (incognito) window the browser forgets them when the window closes.

Always up to date. When a new version of the WSPR Logger is put on the server, an open app notices it the next time you come back to it, and reloads itself (Section 5). You never need to clear the browser's cache.

2 The screen

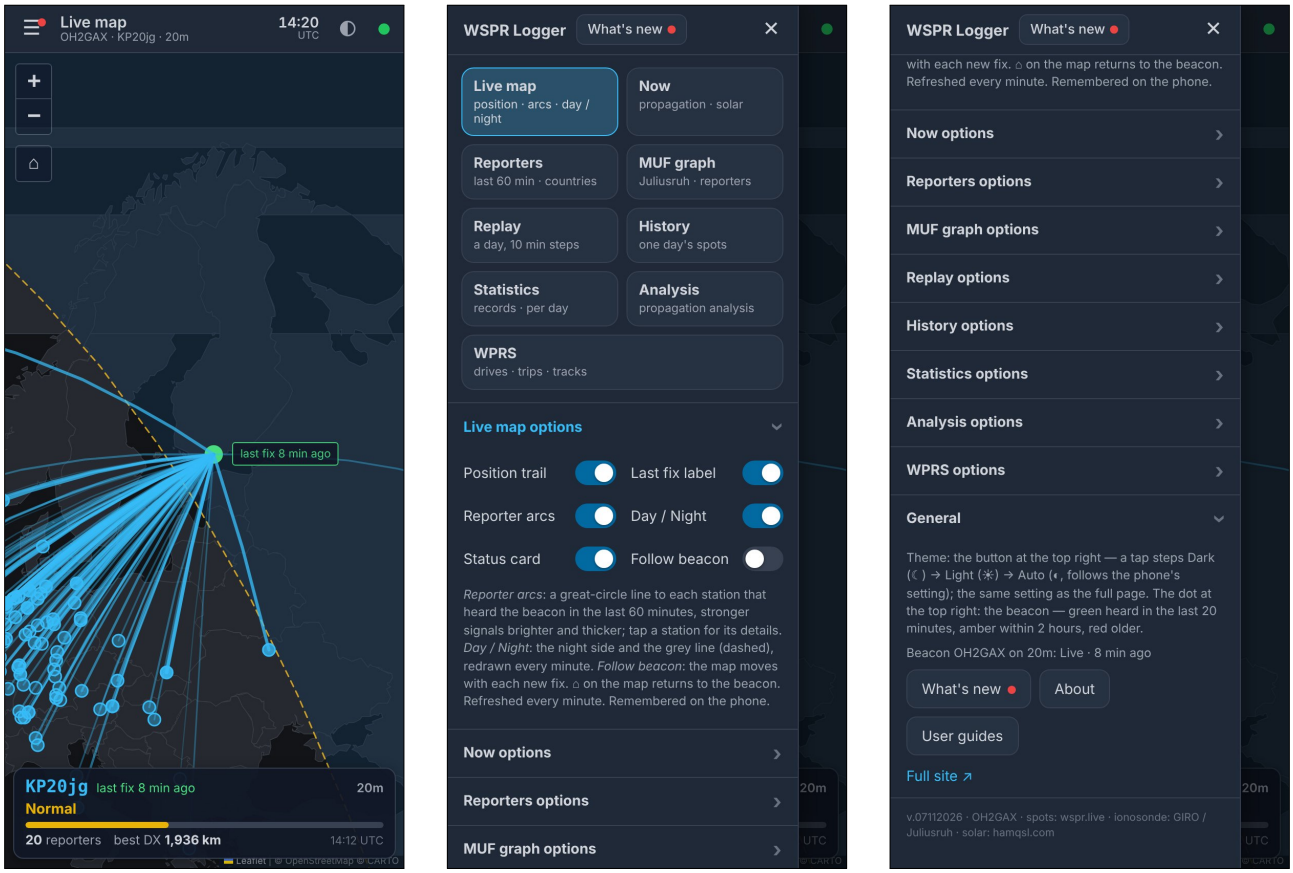


Figure 1. The Live map view (left), the menu opened with ≡ (middle), and the General section at the bottom of the menu (right).

The top bar. From left to right:

- ≡ opens the menu. A **red dot** on it means there are new notes in What's new that you have not read yet;
- the **title** of the view, and under it a short subtitle: the callsign, the latest locator and the band on the live views, the shown day on Replay and History;

- the **UTC clock**. All times in WSPR Logger are UTC (Finnish time is UTC + 2, in summer UTC + 3);
- the **theme button**. Its icon shows the setting in use: a moon for Dark, a sun for Light, a half-filled circle for Auto (follows the phone's own light/dark setting, also while the app is open). A tap steps Dark → Light → Auto → Dark; a short note under the button names the new setting. The setting is shared with the full page in the same browser;
- the **status dot** of the beacon: **green** when the newest transmission was heard less than 20 minutes ago, **amber** up to 2 hours, **red** beyond (the car is parked with the transmitter off, or nobody hears it). The same text is in the menu under General.

The views. Each view fills the screen below the top bar. Long views (Now, Reporters, History, Analysis, WPRS) scroll up and down; the map views fill the screen exactly. Turn the phone sideways for a wider map: on Replay the time panel then moves beside the map (Figure 5).

3 The menu

The menu slides in from the left. Tap ×, the darkened page on the right, or the phone's Back gesture to close it.

The view tiles. The nine views are tiles at the top. A tap opens the view and closes the menu; the tile of the shown view is highlighted.

The options. Under the tiles each view has a folding section with its options, e.g. Live map options. The section of the shown view opens by itself and its title is blue; the others stay folded but can be opened (and changed) at any time. Below the choices each section has a short explanation of the view. The options are

- **chips** — a row of buttons of which one is on (filled blue), e.g. the range of the MUF graph;
- **switches** — on (blue, knob right) or off, e.g. Reporter arcs on the map;
- **date steppers** — ⟨ date ⟩: the arrows step a day, a tap on the date opens the phone's calendar.

Every choice takes effect at once and is remembered on the phone.

General. The last section has What's new (the short notes of each version, newest first, the same as on the full page), About (the station and the software) and User guides (the PDF guides of the Guides list, this one among them), and the Full site link. What's new is also at the top of the menu next to the title. These open as a full-screen sheet; its top row has buttons for the other two, and × or Back closes it.

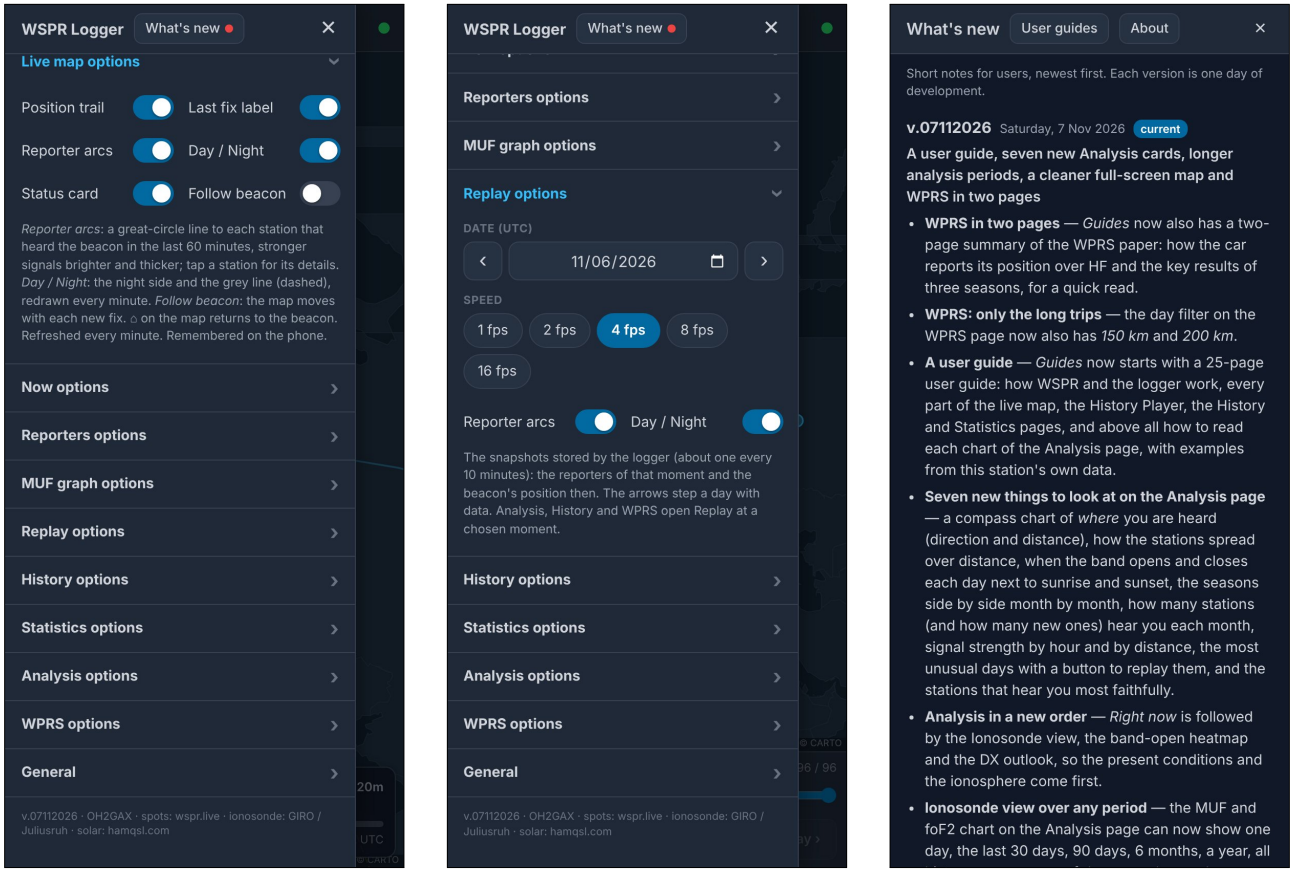


Figure 2. Options of the Live map (left) and of Replay (middle) in the menu, and What's new (right).

4 The views

4.1 Live map

The car's latest position on the map, as on the full page's Live Map.

- The **dot** is the latest fix: green, or red when nothing has been heard for an hour. Its **label** tells how old the fix is — green up to 25 minutes (a transmission every 10 minutes plus the upload delay), amber to an hour, red beyond. Tap the dot for the locator, time, stations and farthest station.
- The **status card** at the bottom: the locator, the age of the fix, the band, the **propagation estimate** with its bar (Section 4.2), the number of stations that heard the latest transmission, the farthest one and the time.
- + / − zoom (or pinch), the **house button** brings the map back to the car.

Options: Position trail (the day's positions as a dashed line), Last fix label, Reporter arcs (a great-circle line to every station that heard the beacon in the last 60 minutes — the stronger the signal, the brighter and thicker the line; tap a station's dot for its callsign, grid, SNR, distance and country), Day / Night (the night side shaded and the grey line dashed, moved every minute), Status card, and Follow beacon (the map moves with each new fix). The view is refreshed every minute.

4.2 Now

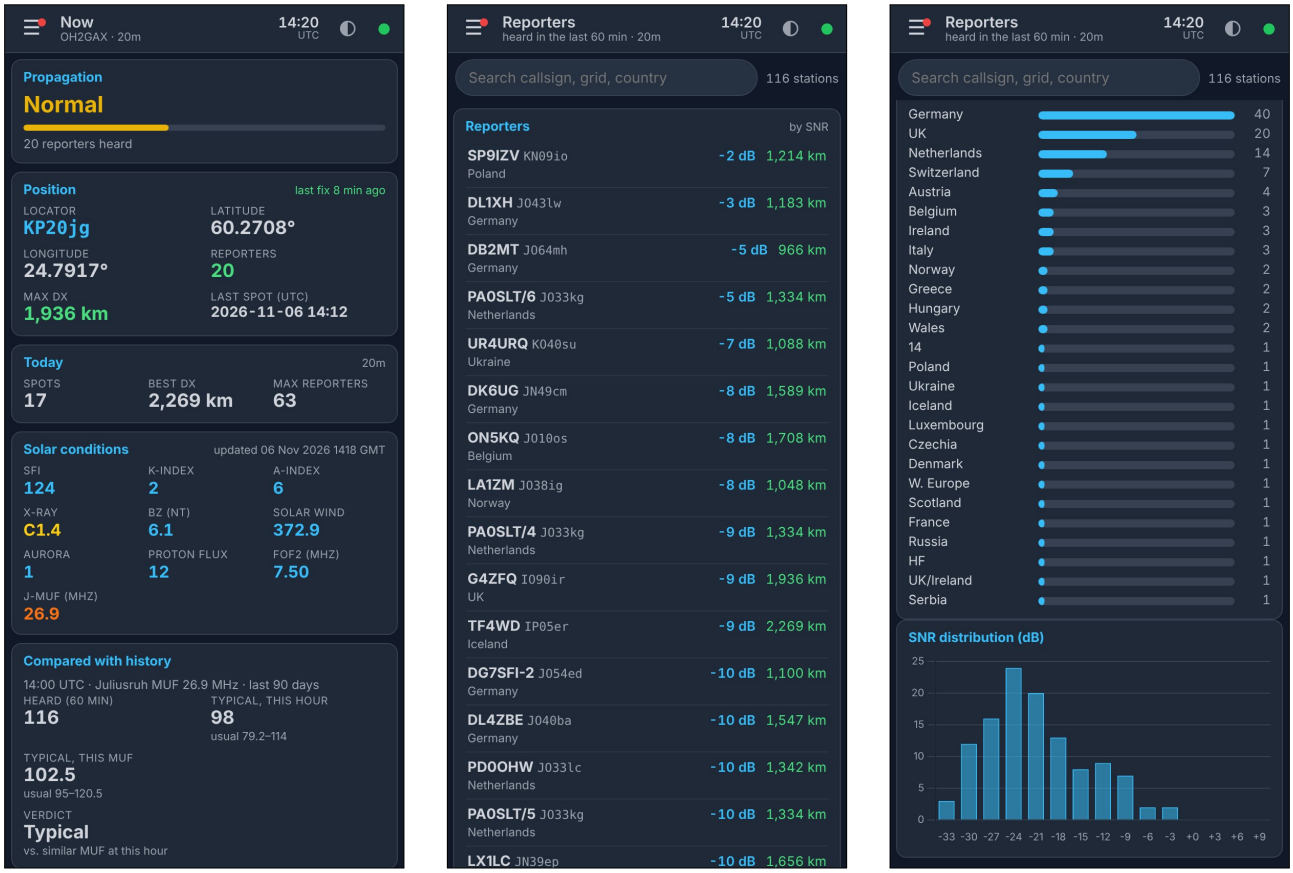


Figure 3. Now (left); Reporters: the list (middle) and, further down, the countries and the SNR distribution (right).

The present situation in numbers, card under card:

Propagation the number of stations that heard the latest transmission, as a word and a bar: Very low (≤ 5), Low (≤ 10), Normal (≤ 20), Good (≤ 40), Very good (≤ 60), Extremely good (≤ 100), Exceptional. **& DX** is added when two or more of the stations heard in the last hour are beyond 6 000 km, and **HIGH MUF** when the Juliusruh MUF is above 28 MHz. *No propagation* means nothing was heard for an hour (on 20 m in the daytime, 06–15 UTC, the app says *No propagation or TX Fail*, because silence then is suspicious).

Position the locator, the coordinates, the stations and farthest station of the latest transmission, its time and the age of the fix.

Today / Last hour the transmissions heard, the best distance and the most stations of one transmission — for today (UTC) or the last 60 minutes (option Spots of).

Solar conditions the space weather of hamqsl.com and the Juliusruh ionosonde, coloured as on the full page's Solar panel: green and blue quiet or good, yellow, orange and red increasingly disturbed, purple extreme. For the MUF the colours go the other way — the higher, the more the band is open.

Compared with history the Analysis page's *Right now* card over the last 90 days: how many stations heard the beacon in the last hour, how many are typical at this hour of the day and at a similar MUF, and the verdict *Better than usual*, *Typical* or *Below usual*.

4.3 Reporters

The stations that heard the beacon in the last 60 minutes (the full page's Reporter list, Reporter countries and histogram), with a **search** field at the top that matches the callsign, the grid or the country anywhere ("germ" finds every German station). Each row shows the callsign, the grid, the country, the SNR and the distance; distances beyond 6 000 km are bold. **Options:** Sort by SNR, distance, callsign or country; Distribution of SNR or distance; and which Sections are shown: the list, the countries (one bar per country, the most stations on top) and the distribution chart. The countries and the chart follow the search, so a search for a country shows its own SNR distribution.

4.4 MUF graph

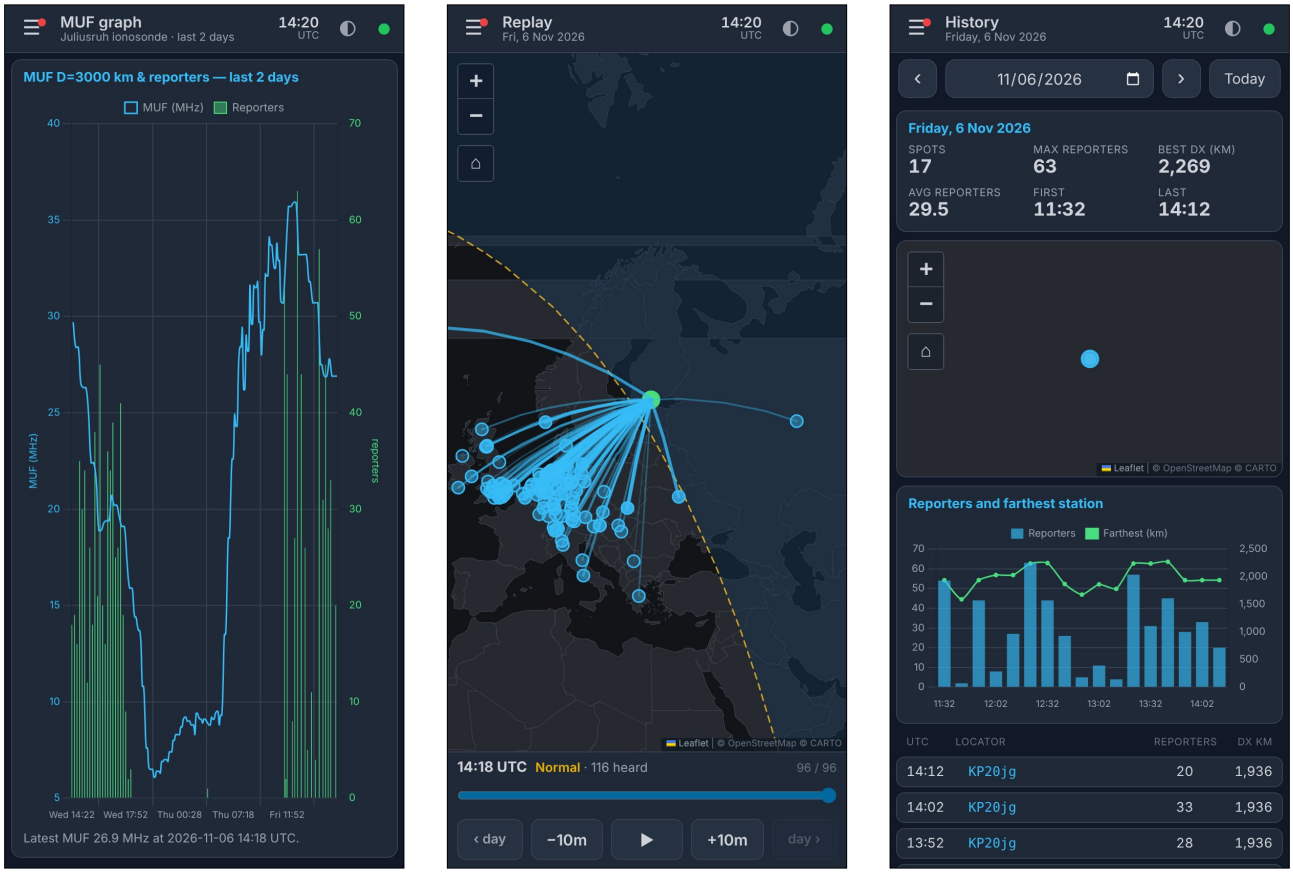


Figure 4. MUF graph (left), Replay (middle) and History (right).

The full page's MUF panel, as large as the screen: the **line** is the maximum usable frequency for a 3 000 km hop measured by the Juliusruh ionosonde (MHz, left scale), the **bars** the stations that heard each transmission (right scale). When the MUF climbs well above 14 MHz the 20 m band opens and the bars grow; in the evening both fall together. Tap the chart for the values of a moment. **Options:** Range 24 h, 2 days, 3 days or 1 week.

4.5 Replay

The full page's History Player: the snapshots stored by the logger, about one every ten minutes, each with the stations that had heard the beacon in the preceding hour.

- The **map** shows the car where it was at that moment, the arcs to the stations of the snapshot and the night side of that moment, and the day's path as a grey dashed line.
- The **panel** below it: the time, the propagation estimate of that moment and the number of stations heard, the snapshot number (e.g. 96 / 96), the **slider** (drag it through the day), and the buttons ⟨ day and day ⟩ (the previous / next day with data), −10m and +10m (one snapshot back / forward) and ▶ (play; ⏸ pauses).

Replay opens at the newest snapshot. **Options:** the Date (UTC) with its stepper (a date without data shows the nearest earlier day with data), the playing Speed (1–16 snapshots a second), and the switches Reporter arcs and Day / Night.

Opened from other views. A tap on a row of **History**, on ▶ in an **Analysis** table (storm days, farthest reporters, unusual days) or on Replay in **WPRS** opens Replay at that very moment. The phone's Back does not return to the previous view; open it again from the menu.

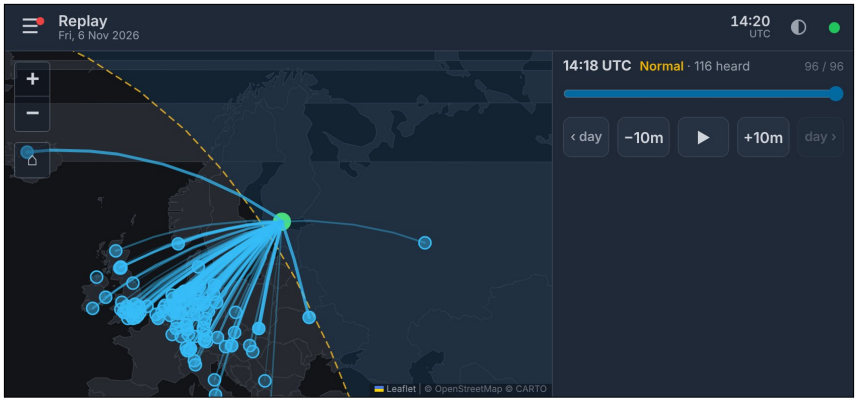


Figure 5. Replay with the phone turned sideways: the panel beside the map.

4.6 History

One UTC day, as the full page's History and Statistics pages together. At the top: ⟨ date ⟩ and Today. Then

- the day's numbers: transmissions heard (*spots*), the most stations of one transmission, the best distance, the average number of stations, and the first and last transmission heard;
- a **map** of the day's positions (green the first, blue the last; tap one for its details; the house button fits the whole day);
- a **chart**: the bars are the stations of each transmission, the line the farthest station;
- every transmission of the day, newest first: time, locator, stations, farthest distance. **Tap a row to open that moment in Replay.**

Options: the Map and the Chart can be switched off for a shorter page.

4.7 Statistics



Figure 6. Statistics (left); Analysis: the top of the view (middle) and further down the band-open heatmap and the DX outlook (right).

The **all-time records**: the transmissions heard so far, the active days, the best distance and the most stations (with the day each record was set), and the first and last transmission ever heard. Below them a **chart day by day**: the bars are each day's best distance, the line the most stations of one transmission that day. **Tap a day in the chart to open it in History.** **Options:** Range 30 days, 90 days or all.

4.8 Analysis

The full page's Propagation Analysis page, with all its cards one under the other in the same order: the summary, Right now, the ionosonde view, the band-open heatmap, the DX outlook, the typical day, the space-weather charts, the grey-line windows, the compass chart of where you are heard, the distance distribution, band opening and closing, season against season, stations per month, signal strength by hour and by distance, unusual days, the storm days, the farthest and the most loyal stations. *How to read each card is explained in Section 5 of the WSPR Logger User guide* (open it from General → User guides).

The **period** buttons (30 d, 90 d, 6 m, 1 yr, All) are at the top of the view and also in the menu (Analysis options → Period); the two stay in step. The buttons inside the cards (e.g. Reporters / Farthest km of the heatmap, the periods of the ionosonde view) work as on the full page. Tap a chart or a heatmap cell for its values. Wide tables (the DX outlook) scroll sideways within their card.

The first opening takes a moment. The Analysis is computed by the server from the whole history and kept ready for ten minutes. The first time after that it may take a few seconds before the cards appear; changing the period does the same. The rest of the app is not slowed down meanwhile.

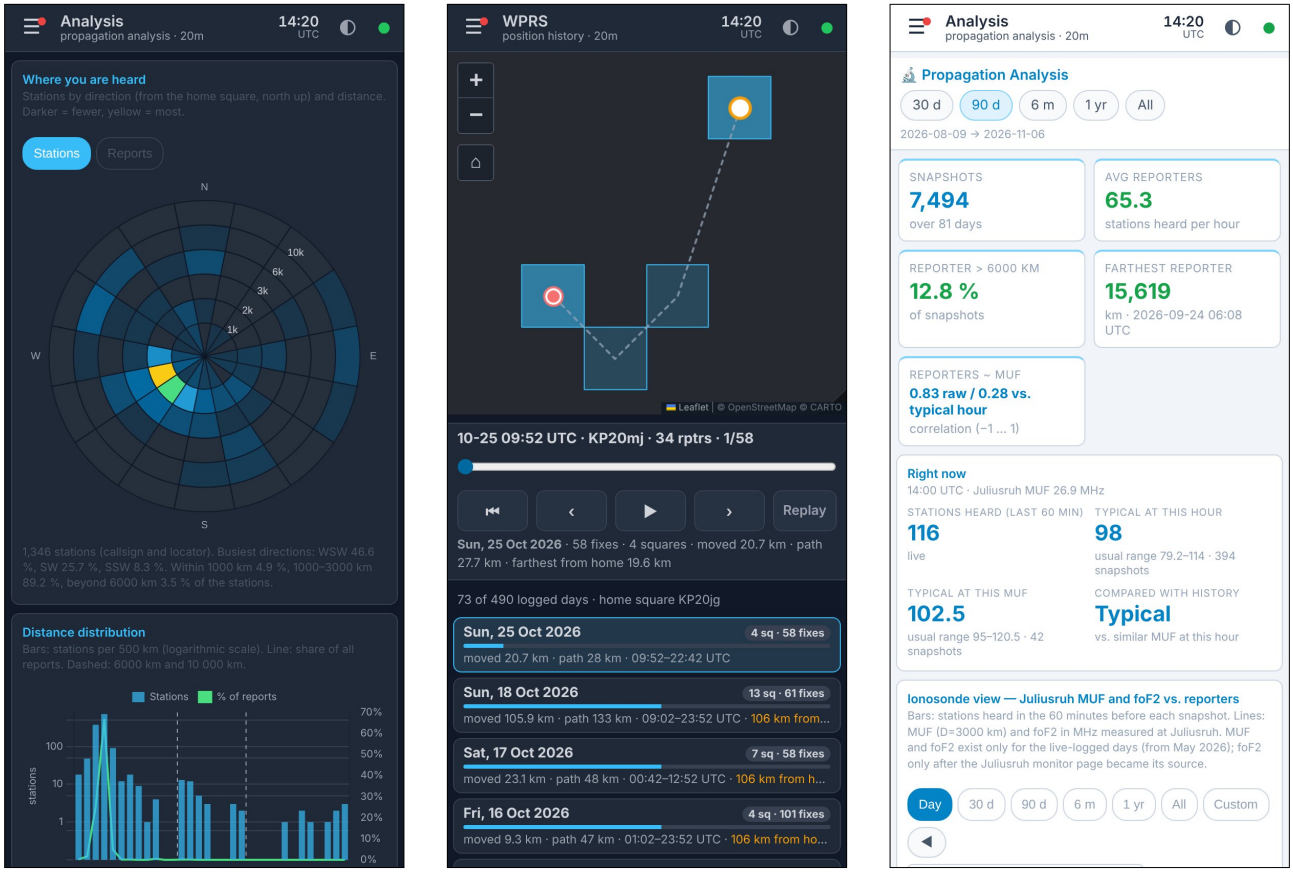


Figure 7. Analysis: where you are heard (left); WPRS with a drive on the map (middle); Analysis in the Light theme (right).

4.9 WPRS

The full page's WPRS page (Whisper Position Reporting System): the positions in the transmissions turned into tracks of the car.

- The **map** at the top shows the chosen day or trip: the Maidenhead squares the car was in (darker: more fixes), the path as a dashed line, the start (green), the end (red) and the home square (red ring). The orange line and ring follow the fix shown below.
- The **panel**: the time, locator and stations of the shown fix, the **slider** over the fixes, ◄◄ (to the start), ⟨ / ⟩ (one fix), ► (play) and Replay (opens the shown fix's moment in Replay). Under the buttons a summary: fixes, squares, how far the car moved, the path length and the greatest distance from home.
- The **list** below: the logged *days* with movement (each with a bar of how far it went), or the *trips* beyond 25 km from home. Tap one to show it on the map; the view scrolls back to the top.

Options: List Days or Trips; Days with movement or distance from home of at least any change of square, 5, 10, 25, 100, 150 or 200 km (the same setting as on the full page); Track of 1–7 days from the chosen day (a trip sets it to its own length); and the playing Speed.

5 Staying up to date

Refreshing. The Live map, Now and Reporters fetch new data every minute and the MUF graph every ten minutes. Only the view on the screen is refreshed, and **nothing at all while the app is not on the screen** (the phone is locked or another app is open), so the app uses no data in the background. The other views load when you open them or change a date or an option.

Coming back. When you return to the app it refreshes the shown view at once. If it has been away for more than an hour, or a new version has been put on the server meanwhile, it reloads itself completely — the view and all your choices stay. A new version also brings a red dot to ≡ and What's new until you have read the notes (the full page then no longer marks them either, in the same browser).

Data use. A refresh of the Live map is about 1 kB, or about 12 kB with the reporter arcs on; the map tiles are loaded as you move the map and kept by the browser. The Analysis view loads about 60–100 kB once per period, Replay about 200 kB per day. The program itself (with the map and chart libraries, about 0.5 MB) is loaded once and then kept by the browser.

6 The phone view and the full page

Full page	Phone view
Live Map: map and layers	**Live map**: trail, fix label, reporter arcs (Reporter Plot) and Day/Night as switches; the overlay as the status card
Left pane: Locator, Propagation, Today / 1h	**Now**
Solar Conditions panel	**Now** → Solar conditions
Reporter list, countries, histogram	**Reporters** (with a search)
MUF panel	**MUF graph**
History Player	**Replay** (always on the map; opened from History, Analysis and WPRS)
History page	**History** (with the day's chart of the Statistics page)
Statistics page	**Statistics** (records and the day-by-day chart) and **History**
Analysis page	**Analysis** (the same cards)
WPRS page	**WPRS**
What's new, Guides, About	**Menu** → General

Table 1. Where the parts of the full page are in the phone view.

The full page has a few things the phone view leaves out: panels that can be moved on the map, the links that open a page at a given drive or date (`#wprs=...`), and the WPRS Copy link button. Open General → Full site for those.

7 Quick reference

View	Shows	Options (menu)
Live map	latest fix, its age, propagation, arcs, night side; every minute	trail, fix label, arcs, day/night, status card, follow
Now	propagation, position, today / last hour, solar, compared with history	today or last hour
Reporters	stations of the last 60 min, countries, distribution	sort, distribution, sections
MUF graph	Juliusruh MUF and stations heard	24 h, 2 d, 3 d, 1 week
Replay	a stored snapshot of any day, playable	date, speed, arcs, day/night
History	one day: numbers, map, chart, every transmission	map, chart
Statistics	all-time records, day-by-day chart	30 d, 90 d, all
Analysis	the Propagation Analysis cards	period
WPRS	days and trips as tracks on the map	list, minimum distance, days, speed

The status dot is red. Nothing has been heard for over two hours: the car is parked with the transmitter off, or the band is closed (at night). The Live map's label tells how old the fix is.

The map is grey. The map tiles come from CARTO over the network; on a slow connection they appear a little later. The data (dots, arcs) does not depend on them.

No replay data for ... The day has no stored snapshots; Replay shows the nearest earlier day that has.

The settings are forgotten. The browser is in private mode, or its site data was cleared.

Something looks odd after an update. Close the app and open it again; it always fetches the newest version.